

Q. My Windows Explorer keeps crashing whenever I do a search, or use Explorer for a long time. I'm running Windows XP + SP1. To zero in on the problem, I monitored Task Manager to see the cause of crash, and disabled all startup programs, including antivirus software. I found a program, Dr. Watson, which starts immediately and causes Explorer to freeze, and then it crashes, and closes all Explorer windows, including Windows Explorer. I'm really frustrated. I tried searching the Microsoft XP online database for a patch, but none was available. What's the solution?

Shankar

A It's not necessarily Dr. Watson that's causing the problem. When an error is reported, Windows starts Dr. Watson, which creates a log file. This log file comprises the current state of the machine. This file can then be sent to the Microsoft technical support for help. Alternatively, you can configure Dr. Watson to create a crash dump file, a binary file that can be analysed with the help of a debugger.

By default, the log file created by Dr. Watson is named Drwtsn32.log, and is saved in the **C:\Documents and Settings\All Users\WINNT\Application Data\Microsoft\Dr Watson** folder.

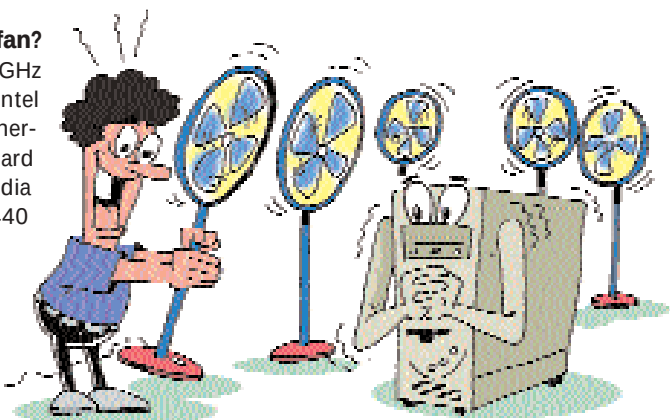
Check the log file for the program that's causing the error. If it's Windows

Fan in another fan?

Q. I have a 1.5 GHz CPU with an Intel 845GBV motherboard, a 40 GB hard disk, an nVidia GeForce4 MX 440 graphics card and a Creative Sound Blaster Live DE 5.1 sound card. Can I use another fan for the graphics card instead of its own fan? If so, what kind of fan should I use? Will it enhance my card's performance?

Udayan

A The fan that comes with the card is more than enough! You need not change or add any more fans to it.



However, you can increase the number of fans in the cabinet, as it might improve the cooling system, and thereby increase the lifespan of the component. Make sure you have a better fan to keep things cool in case you wish to overclock your graphics card for better performance.

Explorer that's causing the problem, the fastest fix is to re-install Windows.

Help on the Internet

Q. My first question is whether it's possible to download attached e-mail files directly from the server—Hotmail or Sify—using FTP commands from within Windows, using the e-mail ID and password, without using a browser?

Second, is it possible to use a 40 GB hard disk on a 486 system? If yes, how?

Lastly, is there a Web site I can go to, for suggestions on these matters?

Manoranjana Mohapatra

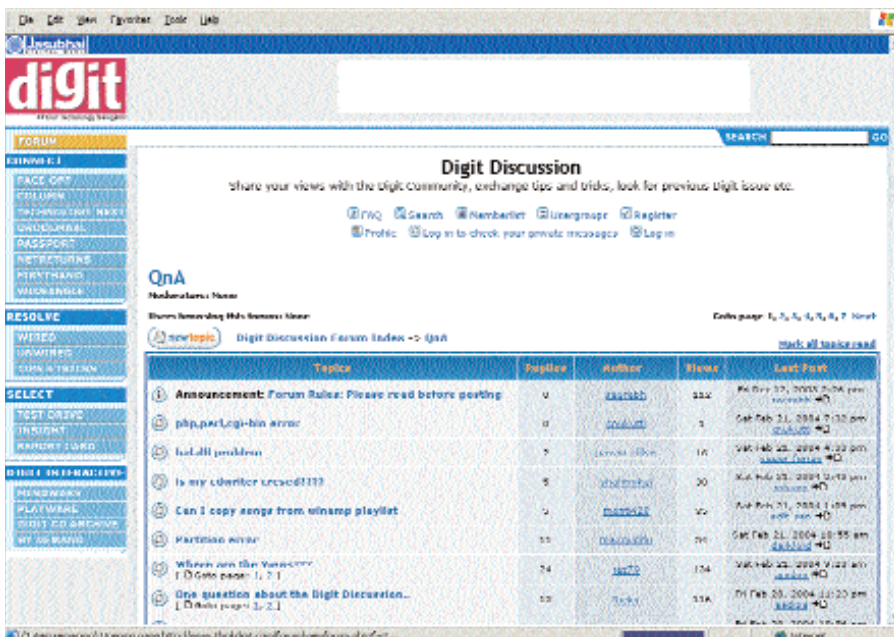
A For your first question, if you mean downloading attachments from e-mails in your Hotmail or Sify mailbox, then you can't. You can download attachments only after logging in via the usual interface. You can, however, download your Hotmail e-mails directly using e-mail clients such as Outlook Express or Outlook.

Now for your second query: Yes, you can, with the help of utilities you can find on the hard disk vendor's Web site. For a Seagate hard disk, go to **www.seagate.com/support/disc/drivers/**, and for Samsung drives, go to **www.samsung.com/Products/HardDiskDrive/utilities/index.htm**.

To answer your last question: We have a forum at **http://www.thinkdigit.com/forum/viewforum.php?f=2** to discuss such issues. You are more than welcome to join us.

Firm wary

Q. I have three questions: What is a firmware update, and what does it do? Which of the following needs regular driver and firmware updates for optimal functionality: Motherboard, chipset, graphics card, sound card, hard disk,



At **http://www.thinkdigit.com/forum/viewforum.php?f=2** you will find the QNA section where you can discuss your problems